

Cooper Debate Team

Website Feature Roadmap

Cooper Middle School, McLean VA | CooperDebateTeam.com

Prepared by Hannah Shiv | July 2026

Vision Statement

Create a secure, visually stunning debate platform that serves prospective students, current team members, parents, guardians, coaches, and alumni. Combine interactive learning, tournament management, resource sharing, and celebration of Cooper Debate's achievements into one cohesive digital experience - replacing and expanding upon the team's existing Schoology group.

Primary Audiences

Prospective Students	7th and 8th graders considering joining the Cooper Debate Team
Parents & Guardians	Families who need to understand commitments, logistics, and requirements
Current Members	Active debaters who need resources, schedules, partner info, and team tools
Coaches	Ms. Konde and any assistant coaches managing the program
Langley Mentors	Langley HS students who support Cooper debaters weekly
Alumni	Former Cooper debaters who went on to high school debate, law, and public service

CRITICAL SITE-WIDE REQUIREMENT: The new application policy must appear in a minimum of 5 locations across the site. All interested students - including returning members - must apply before the deadline. Only Metro Finals qualifiers are automatically on the team. No surprises. This must be unmissable.

Privacy & Access Principles

Per Coach Konde: individual performance metrics that could embarrass students must never be publicly visible. Content meant for Cooper students only lives behind the members login. The site must reflect FCPS guidelines on student data and privacy at all times.

Feature Tiers at a Glance

TIER 1: PUBLIC RECRUITMENT & INFORMATION

Publicly visible - no login required. Primary audience: prospective students and parents.

TIER 2: MEMBERS PORTAL

Login required. Serves current team members, parents, and coaches.

TIER 3: INTERACTIVE LEARNING

Educational tools for debate skill-building. Basic content public; deeper content members-only.

TIER 4: ADVANCED FEATURES

Ambitious enhancements that elevate this platform well beyond a standard team site.

TIER 1 - Public Recruitment & Information

1 Future Debater Journey

COACH #1

- > What is debate? - plain-language explanation for students and parents new to the activity
- > Why Join Debate? - leadership, critical thinking, confidence, friendships, fun, karaoke
- > What is Public Forum? - format overview, what a resolution is, how rounds are structured
- > Round structure chart - Constructive, Rebuttal, Crossfire, Summary, Final Focus with timings
- > Weighing, Framework, and Evidence - linked explainer pages for each concept
- > Meet the Team - coach bios, Langley mentor section, student spotlights

2 Join the Team Hub

COACH #1

- > NEW APPLICATION POLICY alert - prominent, repeated a minimum of 5 times site-wide
- > Eligibility - grades 7 and 8, no prior experience required, open to all beginners
- > Application access - embedded Google Form with confirmation receipt (no disputes)
- > Selection process - info session (late Aug), Activity Fair (early Sept), two tryout dates
- > Key dates - application deadline, tryout dates, first practice, full season calendar
- > Student commitment overview - Tuesdays 2:30-4:30pm; attend 3 of 5 Saturday tournaments
- > Partner commitment policy - no last-minute drops; explained clearly and upfront
- > Contract / agreement link - downloadable PDF once finalized by Coach Konde

3 Parent & Family Information Center

HIGH

- > \$15 per student per year - fee waivers available; stated clearly
- > Required Google Meet sessions - one per semester (October and January)
- > Judge volunteer requirement - at least 1 tournament per family; WASDL training provided
- > Transportation - no FCPS bus service; parents drive or organize carpools
- > Permission slips packet - digital where possible; due by October 1st
- > Tournament day guide - arrival time, round count, dress code, pickup time, parent access
- > Communication channels - how coach reaches parents during tournament day
- > Snack sign-up for team parties

TIER 1 - Continued

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Tournament Center

HIGH

- > Full season calendar - tournament name, host school, date, format, team size attending
- > WASDL circuit explanation - what WASDL is, how the season works, qualification explained
- > Metro Finals section - what it takes to qualify, what it means to compete
- > MS Nationals section - NCFL/NSDA info, Cooper's growing history at nationals
- > Past results table - carefully curated (no data that could embarrass individual students)
- > Tournament day walkthrough - what a typical Saturday looks like from arrival to pickup

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Achievements & Hall of Fame

MEDIUM

- > Season highlights - 90 debaters in prelims; 44 to Metro Finals placing 2nd, 3rd, and 4th
- > Nationals highlight - 7 Cooper students at NCFL Nationals; 4 teams to Octos; 1 in finals
- > Student spotlights - 7th grade team H/J showing anyone can succeed; team L/L win featured
- > All-time program milestones - history, founding year, notable firsts with years
- > Top Speakers archive - speaker award recipients across all seasons
- > Alumni spotlight - former Cooper debaters in college debate, law, and public service

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Langley Mentors Program

MEDIUM

- > Who they are - Langley HS students, many former Cooper debaters, some nationally ranked
- > How the partnership works - weekly visits, skill drills, crossfire practice, topic brainstorming
- > Featured quote - Inger Logan, incoming Langley Debate Team President (cc'd by coach)
- > Mentor profiles - names, debate background, areas they specialize in helping with
- > AI Policy page - link to WASDL's official AI policy with coach's context and guidance

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Team Culture & Gallery

MEDIUM

- > Practice culture - Tuesday sessions in the Lecture Hall; what a typical practice looks like
- > Team traditions - end-of-year parties, karaoke, community events, banquet
- > Photo gallery - tournaments, award ceremonies, practice sessions, team events
- > Video section - recorded rounds, highlight reels, embedded YouTube content
- > Explainer video embed - "What is Public Forum Debate?" for newcomers and parents
- > Photo submission - how parents and students can contribute photos with consent info

TIER 2 - Members Portal (Login Required)

All Tier 2 features require Firebase Authentication. Content is restricted to Cooper Debate Team members only, consistent with FCPS privacy guidelines. Students must not be able to share private content outside the team.

8 Secure Evidence Repository

MEMBERS

- > Case files - team cases organized by resolution and topic
- > Evidence cards - sourced research materials for current and past topics
- > Flow sheets - practice flows from internal debates and past tournaments
- > Private resources - any materials the coach marks as Cooper-only
- > Upload system - coach and members can add files; organized by season

9 Team Dashboard

MEMBERS

- > Announcements - coach posts updates visible only to logged-in members
- > Practice schedule - Tuesday A and B session details, room assignments
- > Partner assignments - who is paired with whom for each tournament
- > Assignments - research tasks, speech prep deadlines, reading assignments
- > Tournament readiness - confirmation tracker showing who has confirmed for each event

10 Full Parent Portal

MEMBERS

- > Digital permission slips - fillable and signable online
- > Judge signup integration - SignUp Genius embed; opens once team roster is finalized
- > Carpooling coordination - tool for parents to organize tournament transportation
- > Google Meet links - for required semester meetings (October and January)
- > Tournament communication - how to reach the coach on tournament day
- > FAQ library - answers to the most common parent questions about the program

11 Tournament History Database

MEMBERS

- > Full historical results - every tournament, searchable by year and team
- > Awards archive - all speaker awards and placements across all seasons
- > Photo albums by year - organized gallery for each season
- > Nationals archive - every Cooper qualification with results and photos
- > NOTE: Individual metrics visible to logged-in members only - never on the public site

TIER 3 - Interactive Learning Features

Educational tools to help students understand debate concepts, master current resolutions, and build skills. Basic explainer content can be public; quizzes and evidence tools work best behind member login.

12 PF Academy - Debate Education Hub

INTERACTIVE

- > Speech types - Constructive, Rebuttal, Summary, Final Focus with examples and time limits
- > Crossfire strategy - techniques, common mistakes, how to control the exchange
- > Weighing guide - magnitude, probability, timeframe; how judges evaluate impacts
- > Framework and evidence - how to structure a case; what makes a credible source
- > Judge tips - what judges look for; how to speak clearly; how to flow
- > Common mistakes - top 3 errors new debaters make (per Coach Konde)
- > Quizzes - self-assessment on debate terminology and concepts

13 Resolution Explorer / Topic Center

INTERACTIVE

- > Current resolution - exact NSDA wording, posted when released (Aug 1 for Sept/Oct topic)
- > "Learn a Topic Fast" guide - Cooper's approach to mastering a new topic in one month
- > Pro/Con breakdown - strongest arguments on each side, curated by coach and members
- > Vocabulary builder - key terms and definitions for each resolution
- > Evidence and sources - links to articles, government reports, academic papers
- > Past resolutions archive - all previous NSDA PF topics with summaries (2024-25, 2025-26)
- > AI Policy - WASDL link plus Coach Konde's guidance on responsible AI use in debate prep

14 Debate Round Simulator

INTERACTIVE

- > Animated round timeline - visual walkthrough of a complete PF round
- > Speech sequence - who speaks when, for how long, and in what order
- > Interactive timers - practice timer for each speech type (prep time included)
- > Sample content - example constructive speech, rebuttal moves, and final focus
- > Ideal for prospective students to experience what a round feels like before joining

TIER 4 - Advanced / Future Features

Ambitious enhancements that would make this platform genuinely exceptional - unlike anything found on a typical middle school team site. Planned for after the core features are stable and being actively used.

15 Debate Arena - Immersive Interactive Experience

FUTURE

- > Choose a side - student picks affirmative or negative on a live resolution
- > Build a case interactively - guided prompts for contentions, evidence, and impacts
- > Practice crossfire - simulated Q&A with sample opponent questions and responses
- > Game-like experience for new students to try debate before committing to applying
- > High potential as a recruitment tool at the Activity Fair in September

16 Ask a Mentor

FUTURE

- > Live or async Q&A connecting Cooper students with Langley mentors
- > Mentor profiles with listed specialties (crossfire, evidence, specific topics)
- > Submit a question - mentor responds within a set number of days
- > Requires coordination with Langley Debate Team leadership (Inger Logan)
- > Could evolve into a structured mentorship matching system over time

Content Sources - What We Have

The following materials are already available or in progress:

Coach's Email (Jul 13, 2026)	Full content brief from Ms. Konde - why join, application policy, student and parent commitments, coach bio, Langley mentors program, AI policy, season stats, and key dates.
Google Slides (Coach Konde)	Coach has existing slides with most content already written. Hannah to request and receive these slides - fastest path to populating page content.
Inger Logan's Debate Manual	Inger (cc'd on coach's email) drafted a debate manual with language directly usable for the PF Academy, round structure, and terminology pages.
73-Question Content Brief	Two-part document sent to coach covering all pages. Coach is actively working through answers. Covers Home, About, Awards, Tournaments, Gallery, Resources, and Blog.
Feature Roadmap PDF (16 features)	Collaborative ideas document provided - all 16 features incorporated and organized into this roadmap's four-tier structure.
Existing Phase 1 Website	Seven public pages already built with the full design system, dome navigation, Cooper Cougars hero image, and placeholder content ready to swap for real data.

Outstanding - Content Needed from Coach Konde

- Google Slides - request resend; most page content already lives in these slides
- Exact dates - info session, Activity Fair, application deadline, two tryout dates, Tuesday A and B session schedule for 2026-27
- Google Form link - updated application form with confirmation receipt
- Student contract / agreement - draft or final version for the site link
- Team L/L result - what did L/L win? (for season highlights section)
- Student photos - with consent documentation for any student shown on the site
- Coach headshot - for About / Coaches section
- Public vs. members-only decision - which content is open, which requires login
- All-time milestones - 3 to 6 historic program moments with years
- Past resolutions - full list for 2024-25 and 2025-26 seasons

DESIGN CARRY-FORWARD: The existing visual identity is approved and carries into all new pages. Navy #0B2545, Gold #D4A017, Cormorant Garamond headings, Josefin Sans body, dome/radial navigation, Cooper Cougars hero image. No redesign needed.

Key Design Decisions Already Made

Navigation	Dome/radial nav - Members circle swapped for Home so every page links back
Privacy	Student metrics never shown publicly; member content behind Firebase login
Application Policy	Appears minimum 5 times site-wide in alert/banner style - unmissable

Hosting	GitHub Pages static hosting; CooperDebateTeam.com target domain; CNAME configured
Phase 2 Auth	Firebase Authentication for members portal; members.html is current placeholder
Credit	Hannah Shiv credited in footer on every page and on the About page coach card